

VPN & Password Troubleshooting Playbook

TECHASSIST IT INFRASTRUCTURE & OPS ENGINEERING GUIDE

This document details advanced troubleshooting procedures for corporate network access, active directory credential synchronization, and VPN client diagnostics.

1. Resolving Active Directory Password Sync Issues

In rare cases, changing your password while disconnected from the VPN can lead to credential desynchronization between your local laptop user profile and domain controllers.

- **Symptom:** Laptop unlocks with old password, but corporate web applications demand the new password.
- **Resolution Steps:**
 1. Connect laptop to internet via Wi-Fi or Ethernet.
 2. Launch GlobalProtect VPN and log in with your **NEW** password.
 3. Once connected, lock your computer (`Win + L` or `Ctrl + Cmd + Q` on macOS).
 4. Unlock the workstation using your **NEW** domain password. This forces Windows/macOS local cached credentials to update.

2. Advanced VPN Connection Troubleshooting

When the standard VPN client fails to establish a tunnel, execute the following diagnostic checks:

Diagnostic Procedure A: DNS Cache Flush

Stale internal DNS entries frequently block tunnel authorization.

- **Windows:** Open CMD as Administrator and run `ipconfig /flushdns`
- **macOS:** Open Terminal and run `sudo dscacheutil -flushcache; sudo killall -HUP mDNSResponder`

Diagnostic Procedure B: Gateway Latency & Route Check

Test reaching the edge gateways directly:

```
ping vpn-gateway-1.techassist.com
```

3. Escalation & Support Ticket Creation

If self-service steps do not resolve access issues, request an IT engineer to intervene. When creating a ticket, ensure you provide:

- Your Employee Asset Serial Number (e.g., `TAG-98231`).

- Exact error message string or screenshot.
- Your current local network IP address and ISP details.